



United States
Attorney's Office
Southern District of Ohio



Ohio doctor agrees to pay \$600,000 to settle False Claims Act allegations

Friday, February 21, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Southern District of Ohio

CINCINNATI – An Ohio physician has agreed to pay the United States \$600,000, plus contingent payments, to resolve False Claims Act allegations that he submitted fraudulent Medicare claims related to electro-acupuncture devices.

Ronald F. Ambrosia, 56, of Powell, Ohio, is a doctor licensed in Ohio who provided electrical nerve pulse stimulation services to patients in facilities across the state.

From 2016 until 2018, Ambrosia allegedly improperly billed Medicare for the application of percutaneous electrical nerve pulse stimulation devices (the "P-Stim Device") in an office setting. The P-Stim Device is a device for treatment of chronic pain that, pursuant to manufacturer's instructions, is affixed behind a patient's ear using an adhesive. Needles are inserted into the patient's ear and affixed using another adhesive. Once activated, the device then provides intermittent stimulation by electrical pulses. It is a single-use, battery-powered device designed to be worn for several days until its battery runs out, at which time the device is thrown away.

The procedures allegedly did not involve any surgery, anesthesia, or take place in an operating room (or even at a facility with such capabilities) but were billed to Medicare as surgically implanted neurostimulators, contrary to repeated guidance from the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services.

Kelly A. Norris, Acting United States Attorney for the Southern District of Ohio, announced the settlement. This matter was investigated by agents with the Department of Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General. Assistant United States Attorneys Linda Mindrutiu and W. Hunter West are representing the United States in this matter.

The claims resolved by the settlement are allegations only and there has been no determination of liability.

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